Structuring the Response Reference

IELTS WRITING TASK 1 · KEEP THIS SHEET HANDY

The Four-Part Shape

A reliable starting structure for line-graph answers, not a compulsory IELTS format.

1. Introduction — one sentence

Paraphrase the question. Change the structure and some vocabulary, but keep every category from the original.

2. Overview — one to two sentences

Summarise the two or three biggest patterns, in general terms. Save detailed figures for the body.

3. Body Paragraph 1 — with figures

First logical group of data, grouped by category or by time period.

4. Body Paragraph 2 — with figures

Remaining data, continuing the same grouping logic as Body Paragraph 1.

⚠️ **Why the overview comes early:** in this course it goes straight after the introduction, so you are less likely to leave it out. It summarises the big picture; save detailed figures for the body paragraphs. (IELTS also accepts an overview at the end.)

Useful Phrases by Part

Phrase	Example in context
Introduction	
The line graph illustrates…	…how many people visited three London museums.
The chart shows…	…the revenue of three coffee shop chains.
…over the period from X to Y	…over the 30-year period from 1990 to 2020.
Overview	
Overall, …	Overall, ownership increased across all age groups.
In general, …	In general, both cities saw passenger numbers rise.
It is clear that…	It is clear that one chain grew far faster than the rest.
Body paragraphs	
Specifically, …	Specifically, the 18–30 age group reached 95% by 2020.
In contrast, …	In contrast, the 65+ age group grew far more slowly.
Meanwhile, …	Meanwhile, Chain C grew only modestly.
Linking the parts	
While X…, Y…	While City A climbed steadily, City B fluctuated.
By the end of the period, …	By the end of the period, passenger numbers in both cities were well above their 2000 levels.

✓ **Grouping rule:** split body paragraphs by category (e.g. similar items together) or by time period (e.g. first half

> vs second half) — pick whichever makes the comparison clearest for your specific graph.